



User Guide

A practical, step-by-step guide to using the Smart Car Park System — for drivers booking a bay, and for operators managing the car park.

Applies to

Smart Car Park System web application

Version

1.0

Audience

Customers & site operators

Date

4 August 2026

Table of Contents

1.	1. Getting Started	Accessing the app, demo accounts
2.	2. Creating an Account	Registration walkthrough
3.	3. Logging In & Out	Sign in, session, sign out
4.	4. Customer Guide	Dashboard, finding & booking, managing bookings, profile
5.	5. Admin Guide	Dashboard, slots, bookings, gates, customers
6.		6. Troubleshooting & FAQ
7.		7. Getting Help

1. Getting Started

The Smart Car Park System is a web application — no download or install is required. Open it in any modern browser (Chrome, Edge, Firefox, Safari) on desktop or mobile; the layout adapts automatically to smaller screens, including a slide-out menu on the dashboard views.

1.1 Two kinds of account

Account type	What you can do
Customer	Search live parking availability, reserve a bay, manage your bookings, get a QR code for barrier entry.
Admin / operator	Manage the parking bay inventory, view and cancel any booking, open/close gates, view registered customers.

Try it instantly with demo accounts

The application ships with two working demo logins so you can explore both sides immediately — no registration required:

Role	Email	Password
Admin	admin@smartpark.io	admin123
Customer	jordan@example.com	customer123

2. Creating an Account

New drivers register from the public homepage. All new self-service accounts are created as customer accounts.

1 Open the homepage and click "Get started"

Found in the top navigation bar, or "Reserve a spot" in the hero section.

2 Choose "Create an account"

On the login screen, follow the link to the registration form.

3 Fill in your details

Full name, email address, and a password of at least 8 characters.

4 Submit the form

You're signed in immediately and taken to your customer dashboard — no email confirmation step.

Note

Each email address can only be used once. If you see "An account with that email already exists", log in instead of registering again.

3. Logging In & Out

3.1 Logging in

1 Go to the login page

Click "Get started" from the homepage, or navigate directly to `/login`.

2 Enter your email and password

Use your own account, or one of the demo accounts in §1.1.

3 You're routed automatically

Customers land on the Customer Overview; admins land on the Admin Overview. You never need to choose which portal to open.

3.2 Staying signed in

Your session is remembered in the browser, so refreshing the page or closing and reopening the tab keeps you logged in. Signing in from a different browser or device starts a separate session.

3.3 Logging out

Click your name at the bottom of the sidebar, then **Log out**. You'll be returned to a signed-out state; any in-progress form entries are not saved.

4. Customer Guide

4.1 Your dashboard (Overview)

Your first stop after logging in. If you have an active parking session it's shown at the top with a quick link to view it; otherwise you'll see a prompt to find parking. Below that are three headline numbers — upcoming bookings, total sessions, and total spent — followed by your five most recent bookings.

smartpark.io/customer		Overview
Active now		Bay B-01 · Level 2
Upcoming bookings		2
Total sessions		7
Total spent		£58.50

4.2 Finding and reserving a bay

Open **Find Parking** in the sidebar to see every bay and its live status.

1 Filter if needed

Narrow the list by zone, or tick "EV charging only" if you drive an electric vehicle.

2 Pick an available bay

Each card shows its level/zone, hourly rate, and whether it has an EV charger. Occupied bays show a disabled "Reserve" button.

3 Click "Reserve"

A form opens for the start and end time of your visit. The default is a 2-hour window starting in a few minutes.

4 Confirm the reservation

You're taken straight to your new booking's detail page with its QR code.

If a bay becomes unavailable

Bay availability is live — if someone else books the same bay a moment before you, you'll see an error message when you confirm. Simply pick a different bay.

4.3 Managing your bookings

Open **My Bookings** to see everything you've reserved, filterable by status:

Status	Meaning
Upcoming	Reserved, start time hasn't arrived yet
Active	Currently within your booked time window
Completed	End time has passed
Cancelled	You cancelled it before it started or ended

Click any booking to open its detail page, which shows the full reservation window, total cost, and a QR code. **Show this QR code at the barrier scanner to enter or exit.** You can cancel any upcoming or active booking from either the list or the detail page — this immediately frees the bay for other drivers.

4.4 Your profile

Open **Profile** to update your name or email, or to change your password. Both forms save independently and confirm success with a message beneath the form.

5. Admin Guide

Admin accounts are not self-service — they are provisioned by the system operator. Once logged in with an admin account, you land on the Admin Overview instead of the customer dashboard.

5.1 Overview dashboard

Four headline numbers — occupancy rate, active bookings, registered customers, and today's revenue — followed by an occupancy-by-level breakdown and a feed of the most recent bookings across every customer.

5.2 Managing parking slots

Open **Parking Slots** to see every bay in a table.

- **Add a slot** — click "Add slot", fill in the bay number, level, zone, hourly rate, and whether it has an EV charger.
- **Edit a slot** — click the pencil icon on any row to change its details.
- **Toggle availability** — click the status badge (Available/Occupied) to flip it directly, useful for marking a bay out of service.
- **Remove a slot** — click the trash icon; you'll be asked to confirm.

5.3 Managing bookings

Open **Bookings** to search and filter every reservation in the system by customer name, bay number, or status. Any upcoming or active booking can be cancelled from here — for example, if a customer calls to cancel by phone, or a bay needs to be freed for maintenance.

5.4 Managing gates

Open **Gates** to see every physical barrier as a card showing its name, location, and current state. Click **Open gate** or **Close gate** to toggle it remotely.

Operational note

Gate control in the current build is a direct manual toggle intended for staff oversight and testing. It is not yet linked to automatic triggers such as a valid QR-code scan — that integration is planned (see the accompanying System Report, §8 and §12).

5.5 Managing customers

Open **Customers** for a read-only list of every registered driver, their email, join date, and how many bookings they've made — useful for support enquiries and identifying frequent users.

6. Troubleshooting & FAQ

"Incorrect email or password" when logging in

Double-check for typos, and confirm you're using the account type you intend (customer vs. admin). Passwords are case-sensitive.

"An account with that email already exists" when registering

You already have an account — use the login page instead.

A bay I wanted disappeared from the list / can't be reserved

Availability is live. If another driver booked it moments before you, it will show as Occupied. Refresh the Find Parking page or pick a different bay.

My booking still shows as "Active" after I've left

A session is marked Active for the full duration of your booked time window, regardless of when you physically leave. If you're finished early, cancel the booking to free the bay for others.

I don't see the sidebar / menu on my phone

On small screens the sidebar is collapsed behind a menu icon (☰) in the top-left of the header — tap it to open the navigation drawer.

Do I need to reserve in advance?

No — but reserving guarantees your bay and lets you skip the queue at the barrier. Drive-in without a reservation is matched to whatever is free on arrival, and popular sites can sell out at peak times.

Can I extend my parking time?

From your booking detail page, cancel and create a new reservation for the extended window if your current bay is still available, or contact the site operator directly for an in-progress extension.

Is my data stored securely?

In this current build, the application runs on a local, in-browser demo dataset by default (see the System Report §6.2 for detail) rather than a live server — it is intended for demonstration and evaluation, not for storing real personal or payment data.

7. Getting Help

For questions about using the system, contact the SmartPark support details shown in the Contact section of the homepage, or reach out to the project maintainer directly.

Channel	Detail
Phone	+44 (0) 114 225 5555
Email	support@smartparking.io

Contact details above are placeholders used throughout the demo build — replace them with real support channels before any public deployment.